

Eggplant Pizza alla Norma

with Mozzarella and Ricotta Salata

Pasta "alla Norma" is a traditional Italian recipe made with fried eggplant, tomato sauce, and ricotta salata. The dish's name honors Sicilian composer Vincenzo Bellini and his famous opera Norma. Our take on "Norma" replaces the noodles with crispy pizza crust, for all the same flavors, and none of the required eating utensils.

35-45 minutes Serves 3 people 570 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 1 eggplant
- 4 ounces mozzarella cheese
- 2 tablespoons flour
- 1 pound pizza dough
- 8 ounces Nello's pizza sauce
- 1 ounce ricotta salata - crumbled
- ⅛ ounce fresh basil
- 1 parchment paper

You'll Need

- 1½ tablespoons + 1 teaspoon olive oil
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 12" large pan
- rolling pin (optional)
- baking sheet

Recipe Tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Pizza dough tends to shrink back. Keep rolling even if it does. Frequently rotating it will help achieve an even shape. If you have trouble rolling it, let it temper at room temperature for 5 minutes before continuing.

If you don't have a rolling pin, wrap a wine bottle (empty or full) in plastic wrap and use it to roll out dough.

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1. Prepare Ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse **eggplant**, halve lengthwise, and cut crosswise into ¼-inch slices. Tear **mozzarella** into small pieces.



2. Sauté Eggplant

Heat **1½ tablespoons olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **eggplant** in a single layer, working in batches if necessary. Season with **½ teaspoon kosher salt** and **pepper** as desired. Sauté, flipping halfway through, until crisp on outside, about 8 minutes total. Transfer to a paper towel-lined plate to drain.



3. Roll Out Pizza Dough

While eggplant sautés, sprinkle **flour** onto a clean dry surface. Using a rolling pin or the heels of your hands, roll and stretch **pizza dough** to about ¼-inch thickness (see Recipe Tip). Rub **1 teaspoon olive oil** on a parchment-lined baking sheet, then carefully add pizza dough.



4. Assemble Pizza

Spread **marinara sauce** over pizza, leaving a 1-inch border. Add **eggplant** in an even layer. Top with **mozzarella**, then dot over **ricotta salata**.



5. Bake Pizza

Transfer **pizza** to bottom rack of oven and bake until crust is crisp and light golden and cheese is bubbling, 15-20 minutes. Meanwhile, rinse **basil** and tear leaves into bite-size pieces, discarding stems.



6. Plate Pizza

Cut **pizza** into slices, garnish with **basil**, and dig in. Refrigerate any leftovers in an airtight container for up to 3 days.

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